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CHAIRLIFT DAILY INSPECTION CHECKLIST FOR SKI AREAS

A printable pre-opening checklist for chairlifts and surface lifts, and how to keep the daily record your state inspector and insurer expect to see.

BEFORE YOU START

- **Use your lift's own procedure.** Fixed-grip chairs, detachables, T-bars, rope tows and conveyors each have their own checks. This list is the frame; your manual fills it in.
- **One person signs for each lift, each day.** The record shows who inspected, when, and what they found.
- **A failed item stops the lift.** Write down what was found and what was done, and do not open until a passing check is on file.
- **Check the weather first.** Wind, icing and visibility decide whether the lift runs at all, whatever the checklist says.

THE DAILY PRE-OPENING CHECKLIST

Print one per lift per day, or keep it on a phone. Tick each item, and write a note beside anything that is not right.

CONDITIONS

- ☐ **Wind** at the top and bottom stations, against your lift's limits
- ☐ **Ice and rime** on the haul rope, sheaves, chairs and ramps
- ☐ **Visibility** along the line, enough to see the full length if your procedure requires it
- ☐ **Snow on the line**: nothing touching the chairs, rope or towers, and clearance under the chairs

STATIONS AND LOADING AREAS

- ☐ **Load and unload ramps** groomed, level and the right height; no ruts or bare spots
- ☐ **Maze and lines** set, with ropes, fences and signs in place
- ☐ **Signs** at loading and unloading: rules, restraint bar, "prepare to unload", the lift's sign code
- ☐ **Stop switches and emergency stops** at each station tested and working
- ☐ **Communication** between stations tested: phone or radio, both directions
- ☐ **Operator huts** clear, heated where needed, with the lift's procedures at hand

THE LINE

- ☐ **Walk or ride the line** as your procedure requires, looking at towers, sheave trains and the rope
- ☐ **Sheaves and liners**: nothing unusual in how they run, sound or look
- ☐ **Rope position** on the sheaves and through the stations

- [ ] **Chairs and grips**: restraint bars, seats, footrests and hangers as your manual lists
- [ ] **Tower ladders, signs and padding** in place

DRIVE AND SAFETY SYSTEMS

- [ ] **Brakes** tested as your manual describes
- [ ] **Safety circuits** and stop devices tested
- [ ] **Backup drive** or evacuation drive ready to use
- [ ] **Gauges and readings** within their normal range, written in the log

EVACUATION READINESS

- [ ] **Evacuation plan** for this lift known to the crew on duty
- [ ] **Rope rescue equipment** in place and checked
- [ ] **Enough trained people on duty** to run an evacuation, or a plan to get them

THE TEST RUN AND SIGN-OFF

- [ ] **Run the lift empty** for the time your procedure sets, watching and listening at each station
- [ ] **A test ride** by a crew member before the public loads, if your procedure requires it
- [ ] **Every item above passed**, or the lift stays closed with the reason written down

Lift	Inspected by	Date and time

WHAT A GOOD DAILY RECORD LOOKS LIKE

An inspection that isn't written down is hard to prove. A good record answers five questions for each lift, each day:

1. **Who** inspected it, by name, with their training up to date.
2. **When** the inspection finished, and when the lift opened.
3. **What** was checked, item by item, against your procedure.
4. **What was found**, in plain words, with any problem described as it was seen.
5. **What was done**: fixed, deferred with a work order, or the lift kept closed.

Keep the daily record with the lift's operational log and maintenance records. Holds during the day (wind holds, a stop for a fallen rider, a mechanical problem) belong in the same record, with the time stopped, the time restarted and the reason.

On the first morning of the season, when every lift, trail and crew is checked at once, start from the ski area opening day checklist.

Sources: Wisconsin Department of Safety and Professional Services, ski lift FAQ (quoting ANSI B77.1-2011). This guide is general information, not engineering or legal advice.

The full guide, with common questions: www.runmyresort.com/chairlift-inspection-checklist. Have your insurer and attorney review any procedure before you adopt it.